

FREE BONUS

Piece Cleaning & Care Guide

How to clean, maintain, and protect your handmade pieces

Your customers will ask: "How do I wash this?" This guide gives you the answers — plus a printable care card to include with every sale. Professional sellers include care instructions. Be professional.

Cleaning by Material Type

Cotton Cord Pieces

Cotton is the most forgiving material to clean. Here's the safe method:

1. Shake off loose crumbs and debris
2. Spot clean stains immediately with a damp cloth + mild soap
3. For deep cleaning: submerge in cool water with a drop of dish soap
4. Gently press (don't wring or twist) to remove excess water
5. Lay flat on a towel, reshape, and air dry completely
6. Once dry, press under heavy books for 2-4 hours to flatten

Never: Machine wash, use bleach, tumble dry, or iron directly on the cord. Heat can melt the plastic canvas underneath.

Jute & Hemp Pieces

Natural plant fibers are less water-friendly. Use dry methods when possible:

1. Shake vigorously to remove crumbs and dust
2. Use a lint roller or soft brush for surface cleaning
3. Spot clean only — jute absorbs water and can develop mildew
4. If you must wet clean: barely damp cloth, blot don't rub, dry immediately
5. Deodorize by sprinkling baking soda, letting it sit 15 min, then shaking off

Metallic Cord Pieces

Metallic cords tarnish and fray with water. Clean dry only:

1. Dust with a soft, dry cloth
2. Use a soft-bristle toothbrush for textured areas
3. For stubborn marks: rubbing alcohol on a cotton swab, dabbed carefully
4. Store in a cloth bag away from humidity

Stain Guide

Stain Type	Treatment	Notes
Wine / juice	Blot immediately with club soda, then cool water	Act within 5 min for best results
Oil / grease	Sprinkle cornstarch, let sit 30 min, brush off	May need 2-3 applications
Coffee / tea	Cool water + white vinegar (1:1), blot gently	Don't let it dry first
Candle wax	Freeze with ice, then peel off carefully	Use a butter knife for residue
Food / sauce	Scrape off solids, then spot clean with mild soap	Rinse soap thoroughly

Long-Term Care & Storage

- **UV protection:** Don't leave pieces in direct sunlight for extended periods — natural fibers fade
- **Humidity:** Store in a dry place. Jute and hemp can develop mildew in damp conditions
- **Stacking:** Place tissue paper between stacked placemats to prevent pattern transfer
- **Shape maintenance:** Store flat, never folded. Rolling is OK for runners if stored loosely
- **Seasonal pieces:** Clean thoroughly before storing. Place in a cotton pillowcase (not plastic — needs airflow)

Printable Care Card

Print this card at business-card size and include one with every sale:

Care Instructions

- Spot clean with damp cloth + mild soap
- Air dry flat — do not machine wash or dry
- Do not bleach or iron
- Store flat in a dry place
- Handmade with love — handle with care ♥



Next step: Print the care card, cut to size, and include one with your next sale.